ngSwitch, ngSwitchCase, ngSwitchDefault Angular Example

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The ngSwitch is an Angular structural directive, which allows us to add or remove DOM elements. It works in conjunction with ngSwitchCase & ngSwitchDefault directives. It is similar to the switch statement of JavaScript to display one element among several possible elements, based on an ngSwitch expression. We will show you how to use these directives using an example. The example includes ngSwitch Example, multiple ngSwitchCase , Loose Equality Checks, etc.

You can download the source code from GitHub

Applies to: Angular 2 (is the latest edition of i.e. Angular 8, Angular 9, Angular 10, Angular 11)

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Angular ngSwitch Directive

The ngSwitch is an Angular directive, which allows us to display one or more DOM elements based on some pre-defined condition.

The following is the syntax of ngSwitch. It contains three separate directives ngSwitch, ngSwitchCase & ngSwitchDefault.

Syntax

```
<container_element [ngSwitch]="switch_expression">
    <some_element *ngSwitchCase="match_expression_1">...</some_element>
    <some_element *ngSwitchCase="match_expression_2">...</some_element>
    <some_element *ngSwitchDefault="match_expression_3">...</some_element>
    <some_element *ngSwitchDefault>...</some_element>
</container_element>
```

ngSwitch

ngSwitch is bound to container_element like div, etc. We assign a switch expression to the ngSwitch via property binding syntax. Angular evaluates the switch_expression at runtime and based on its value displays or removes the elements from the DOM.

ngSwitchCase

ngSwitchCase is bound to an inner_element, which we must place inside the container_element. We use [ ] (Astrix symbol) because it is a structural directive. We also assign a match_expression, which Angular evaluates at runtime. The Angular displays the inner_element only when the value of the match_expression matches the value of the switch_expression else it is removed from the DOM.

If there is more than one match, then it displays all of them.

Note that the ngSwitchCase does not hide the element, but removes them from the DOM.

ngSwitchDefault

ngSwitchDefault is bound to an inner_element, which we must place inside the container_element. But it does not have any match_expression. If none of the ngSwitchCase match_expression matches the switch_expression, then the angular displays the element attached to the ngSwitchDefault.

You can place ngSwitchDefault anywhere inside the container element and not necessarily at the bottom.

You are free to add more than one ngSwitchDefault directive. Angular displays all of them.

Important Points

- You must place ngSwitchCase & ngSwitchDefault inside the ngSwitch directive.
- The angular displays every element that matches the switch_expression
- If there are no matches, angular displays all the elements attached to the ngSwitchDefault directive
- You can place one or more than one ngSwitchDefault anywhere inside the container element and not necessarily at the bottom.
- Any element within the ngSwitch statement but not attached to any ngSwitchCase or ngSwitchDefault directive is displayed as it is.
- The elements are not hidden but removed from the DOM.
- Angular uses loose equality checks to compare the ngSwitchCase expression with the ngSwitch expression. This means that the empty string "" matches 0.
- You can share the template between multiple ngSwitchCase using the ngSwitchAttr

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ngSwitch Example

Create a new Angular project. Add the bootstrap CSS to the project by adding the following in the index.html

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="https://maxcdn.bootstrapcdn.com/bootstrap/4.4.0/css/bootstrap.min.css">
```

Component Class

Create a variable user in your Angular Component class

```
user: number = 1;
```

Template

```
<h1 class="text-primary">
  ngSwitch Example
</h1>
<div [ngSwitch]="user">
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="1">Admin</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="2">Editor</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="3">Author</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</h2>
</div>
```

Now let us examine the code in detail

```
[ngSwitch] = "user"
```

We bind the num variable to the input box.

```
<h2 *ngSwitchCase="1">Admin</h2>
```

We attach the ngSwitch directive to the div element, then bind it to the expression num.

```
<h2 *ngSwitchCase="1">Admin</h2>
```

Next, we have a few ngSwitchCase directives attached to the div element with matching expressions "1","2" etc. Whenever the num matches these expressions, the ngSwitchCase displays the element attached to it else it removes it from DOM.

```
<h2 *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</h2>
```

The ngSwitchDefault does not take any expression, but it is displays only when all other ngSwitchCase match expressions fail.



More Examples

The following uses the array of objects instead of a variable.

Component class

```
export class AppComponent {
  name: string;
  num: number;

export class AppComponent {
  name: string = 'Linda';
  num: number = 1;
  users = [{id: 1, name: 'Linda'}, {id: 2, name: 'Peter'}, {id: 3, name: 'Mary'}, {id: 4, name: 'Jack'}];
  selectedValue1: string = 'One';
  selectedValue2: string = 'One';
  selectedValue3: string = 'One';
  selectedValue4: string = 'One';
```

Template

Note that we have two matches for "ngSwitchCase='Two'". ngSwitchCase renders both.

```
<h1 class="text-primary">
  ngSwitch Example
</h1>
<div [ngSwitch]="selectedValue1">
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'One'">One is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'Two'">Two is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'Two'">Two Type Card is Another Answer</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</h2>
</div>
```

You can also make use of ng-template directly instead of ngSwitchCase. In fact ngSwitchCase="One" is a shortcut to ng-template [ngSwitchCase]="One".

```
<h1 class="text-primary">
  ngSwitch Example
</h1>
<select [(ngModel)]="selectedValue2">
  <option *ngFor="let item of items" [value]="item.name">{{item.name}}</option>
</select>

<div [ngSwitch]="selectedValue2">
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'One'">One is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'Two'">Two is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'Three'">Three is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</h2>
</div>
```

More than one ngSwitchDefault. Works perfectly ok.

```
<h1 class="text-primary">
  ngSwitch Example
</h1>
<select [(ngModel)]="selectedValue3">
  <option *ngFor="let item of items" [value]="item.name">{{item.name}}</option>
</select>

<div [ngSwitch]="selectedValue3">
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'One'">One is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="'Two'">Two is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</h2>
</div>
```

Loose Equality Checks

Angular uses loose equality checks to compare the ngSwitchCase expression with the ngSwitch expression. This means that the empty string "" matches 0.

```
<h1 class="text-primary">
  ngSwitch Example
</h1>
<div [ngSwitch]="empty_string">
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="0">Zero is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="1">One is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchCase="2">Two is Selected</h2>
  <h2 *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</h2>
</div>
```


Multiple / Sharing ngSwitchCase

You may also want to share the template between two values. For Example One Template for the values One & Two & another template for values Nine & Ten. One option is to repeat the template under each switch case. Or you can also make use of the ngSwitchAttr to share the template as shown below.

```
<h1 class="text-primary">
  ngSwitch Example
</h1>
<div [ngSwitch]="selectedValue4">
  <ng-container *ngSwitchCase="'One'">
    <ng-container *ngTemplateOutlet="sharedTemplate"></ng-container>
  </ng-container>
  <ng-container *ngSwitchCase="'Two'">
    <ng-container *ngTemplateOutlet="sharedTemplate"></ng-container>
  </ng-container>

  <ng-container *ngSwitchCase="'Three'">
    <ng-container *ngTemplateOutlet="sharedTemplate"></ng-container>
  </ng-container>

  <ng-container *ngSwitchCase="'Four'">
    <ng-container *ngTemplateOutlet="sharedTemplate"></ng-container>
  </ng-container>

  <ng-template #sharedTemplate>Shared Answer 1,2,3,4</ng-template>
  <ng-container *ngSwitchCase="'Nine'">Nine is Selected</ng-container>
  <ng-container *ngSwitchCase="'Ten'">Ten is Selected</ng-container>
  <ng-container *ngSwitchDefault>No Match</ng-container>
</div>
```

Source Code

You can download the source code from GitHub

References

1. ngSwitch
2. ngSwitchCase
3. ngSwitchDefault

Read More

1. Angular Directives
2. ngIf
3. ngSwitch
4. ngIf
5. ngClass
6. ngStyle

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2 thoughts on "ngSwitch, ngSwitchCase, ngSwitchDefault Angular Example"

VIJAY GAURAV
JANUARY 12, 2020 AT 9:48 AM

Very Good Article
Thanks for post useful tutorial

I have one suggestion here. You explain with good example all elements of angular but if you post not just screen other angular implementation example its best to compare other site post.

Reply

TUTSTUTORIALSHUB
JANUARY 12, 2020 AT 1:53 PM

Thanks Vijay.

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